

GRADUATE PROGRAM in **COMPLEXITY SCIENCE**

An initiative of the CSH Digital Innovation School

APPLICATION PROCESS

The application must be initiated through the online application portal, accessible from the program page: csh.ac.at/education/graduate-program or jobs page: csh.ac.at/jobs

Incomplete or late applications will not be considered. It is the responsibility of the applicant to allow sufficient time to ensure that all steps are completed by the deadlines.

Consult the [program FAQ](#) for additional details.

Remaining questions can be addressed to grad@csh.ac.at

APPLICATION REQUIREMENTS

Applications must be completed in English.

STEP 1. Submit biographical information, your cv, and a portfolio of your work (max. 1 page) through the online application portal. The cv and portfolio should be combined into a single pdf. The portal closes on **15 October 2026***.

STEP 2. Send your responses to our specific questions to applications@csh.ac.at by **20 October 2026***. Send via the email address with which you registered in STEP 1. Do not include any other addresses in cc.

STEP 3. Ensure two referees have sent their recommendations to applications@csh.ac.at by **01 November 2026***. Provide your referees with our instruction sheet, available [here](#).
» https://csh.ac.at/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/CSH-DIS_PhD_recommender_instructions.pdf

STEP 4. *If invited*, complete a preliminary online interview by **10 November 2026***. Selected candidates will receive an invitation with instructions only after completing STEP 2 and passing an eligibility check and preliminary review.

** All deadlines are midnight [24:00] Vienna local time.*

Application documents checklist [see [page 2 for detailed instructions](#)]

- [curriculum vitae \(CV\)](#)
- [portfolio of work](#) (max. 1 page)
- [answers to our specific questions](#) (see below; max. 2 pages)
- [two letters of recommendation](#), sent directly from your recommenders to applications@csh.ac.at

*All documents should be submitted as pdf files. Please ensure you pdf is **not** password-protected and adhere to the specified page limits.*

APPLICATION DOCUMENTS :: Detailed Instructions

STEP 1.

curriculum vitae (CV)

- » There is no required template or format.
- » Your submission should include all academic degree programs in which you have been enrolled and all relevant work and research experiences, with corresponding dates.
- » An *optional* cv template (in LaTeX) is available here:
https://csh.ac.at/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/CSHDIS_CV_template.zip

portfolio of work • max. 1 page

- » Your portfolio may include anything you have created, such as scientific products (papers, patents, data visualizations, equipment, code, etc) as well as products from other domains, including but not limited to art, music, literature, hobbies, and personal interests.
- » A comprehensive list is not required. The list should briefly explain why you included the selected inventions. Please provide a link to any of your works that are available digitally.
- » The portfolio is not the same as your cv: The portfolio is a selection of your “favorite” or most relevant projects, the contents are not restricted to research products, and you will offer a brief explanation for why you have included each item.

STEP 2.

answers to the following questions • max. 2 pages

1. *Describe a research project you were involved in and your individual contribution. What specific methods or tools did you use? Describe one part of your work that didn't go as expected – what happened and what did you learn about the approach, research design, dataset, etc.?*
2. *Identify one specific discovery from a CSH research group that you've read about. Summarize that discovery in one sentence using your own words. What is one unanswered question that this research left you with? What do you find most interesting about that question?*
3. *Describe a problem, question, or conceptual space you might want to explore during your PhD. Your idea doesn't need to be a fully formed research plan, but you should give a specific statement of the issue and why you think it's both tractable (i.e. you could make progress on this) and worth studying (i.e. why is it important and for whom?). You are welcome to develop your own ideas or take inspiration from our list of springboard projects (this list is updated regularly).*

STEP 3.

two letters of recommendation

- » Your recommenders should be people who can address your potential as an independent researcher, scholar, and PhD candidate. They should be established professionals (not peers) and know your accomplishments well (e.g. through a closer supervisory relationship)
- » Instructions for recommenders available here:

https://csh.ac.at/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/CSH-DIS_PhD_recommender_instructions.pdf

- ➔ Letters should be sent directly by the recommender to applications@csh.ac.at. Letters sent by applicants cannot be accepted.